

MODULE 43 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

The Stale Catalogue

Services in every old study guide that no longer exist. Reclaim the revision time.

DOMAIN Cross-cutting EXAM WEIGHT All four MODULE 43 of 44

Dead and unexaminable is revision time to reclaim. **Dead and still on the list is an answer you must still give.**

AWS publishes a lifecycle now

- ◆ **Maintenance:** closed to new customers, no new features. Existing customers unaffected, and AWS keeps operating it.
- ◆ **Sunset:** a published end date, typically about twelve months out, when AWS ends operations and support.
- ◆ **Full shutdown:** removed from the portfolio entirely, and no longer available or supported in any capacity.
- ◆ The **AWS Product Lifecycle page**, introduced May 2025, plus recurring Service Availability Updates, is where to check.

ON THE EXAM

This structure only exists because the 2024 closures were communicated so poorly. There is now a page you can check in thirty seconds.

Fully shut down: gone entirely

SERVICE	GONE SINCE
AWS OpsWorks Stacks	26 May 2024 – disabled for existing customers too
AWS CodeStar	25 July 2024
Amazon Elastic Transcoder	13 November 2025
AWS IoT Analytics	15 December 2025
Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL	27 January 2026
CloudWatch Evidently	17 October 2025

ON THE EXAM

OpsWorks is the one to notice: it was disabled for existing customers as well, which is rarer than closing to new ones.

Closed in 2024, still taught everywhere

SERVICE	STATUS AND REPLACEMENT
AWS CodeCommit	Closed 25 Jul 2024. Use GitHub, GitLab or similar
AWS Cloud9	Closed 25 Jul 2024. Use IDE toolkits or CloudShell
AWS Data Pipeline	Closed 25 Jul 2024. Use Step Functions or Glue
Amazon CloudSearch	Closed 25 Jul 2024. Use OpenSearch Service
Amazon QLDB	Discontinued. Use Aurora PostgreSQL
AWS App Mesh, FSx File Gateway	Closed October 2024

ON THE EXAM

The July 2024 wave also included SimpleDB, Forecast and S3 Select. None is on the C02 in-scope list, so none needs revising.

Dead but still examinable

SERVICE	WHY YOU STILL LEARN IT
AWS Migration Hub	Closed Nov 2025, still on the in-scope list
Application Discovery Service	Closed Nov 2025, still on the list
AWS Snow Family	Closed Nov 2025, support ends Dec 2026, still listed
AWS App Runner	Maintenance Mar 2026, still listed
Simple AD	Closed Jul 2026, still listed
Systems Manager Change Manager	Closed to new customers, SSM is listed

ON THE EXAM

This is the group module 42 covered. The test is not whether you can buy it. It is whether the exam guide names it.

Triaging your own material

- ◆ **Take the in-scope service list as your index.** Anything a guide covers that is not on it is optional at best.
- ◆ **A chapter on CodeCommit or Cloud9 dates the guide precisely.** It was written before mid-2024.
- ◆ **Check anything unfamiliar against the Product Lifecycle page.** It takes seconds and settles the question.
- ◆ Do not discard a dated guide. Its explanations of behaviour are usually still sound, as module 42 argued.

ON THE EXAM

The in-scope list is the syllabus. A guide's table of contents is one author's guess at it, made on a date you can often infer.

A practice exam offers AWS OpsWorks as the correct answer to a configuration-management question about Chef recipes across a fleet. The explanation is detailed and technically accurate about how OpsWorks Stacks worked.

The candidate has never heard of it.

What should the candidate conclude?

- A The question predates May 2024; OpsWorks Stacks is fully shut down and is not on the in-scope list. Skip it
- B Learn OpsWorks, since it appeared in a practice exam
- C Learn Chef instead, as the underlying technology
- D Assume the practice exam is authoritative and the exam guide is out of date

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the candidate conclude?

- A

Dated question; skip it

OpsWorks Stacks reached end of life in May 2024 and was disabled for existing customers too. It is not on the in-scope list, so it cannot be a correct answer.
- B

Learn it

Hours spent on a service that no longer exists and cannot appear. A detailed explanation is not the same as a current one.
- C

Learn Chef

Configuration management concepts are useful, and Chef specifically is not what the exam tests. Systems Manager is.
- D

Trust the practice exam

The exam guide is the syllabus. A third-party practice bank is one author's interpretation, on a date you can often infer.

THE SIGNAL

The explanation being accurate is what makes it convincing. It was accurate. The service is gone, which the explanation cannot tell you.

A candidate's study guide devotes a full chapter to AWS CodeCommit, covering repositories, triggers, approval rules and integration with CodePipeline. Another chapter covers Cloud9 as the recommended development environment.

The candidate has three weeks before the exam.

How should the candidate allocate that time?

- ☐ A Skip both chapters: neither service is on the in-scope list, and both closed to new customers in July 2024
- ☐ B Study both, since CodePipeline integration is in scope
- ☐ C Study CodeCommit but skip Cloud9
- ☐ D Study both quickly, in case they appear

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the candidate allocate that time?

- A

Skip both
Neither is on the in-scope list. CodePipeline is, and it is examined through its own behaviour rather than through a source-control service.
- B

Study both
CodePipeline being in scope does not put CodeCommit in scope. Pipelines source from many places, and the exam tests the pipeline.
- C

CodeCommit only
Splits the difference for no reason. Both are equally closed and equally absent from the list.
- D

Study both quickly
Three weeks is finite. Every hour on an unexaminable service is an hour not spent on the 26% of the exam that is Domain 1.

THE SIGNAL

Two chapters on services closed in 2024 tells you when the guide was written, and therefore what else in it to verify.

A candidate revising migration content spends time learning AWS Migration Hub in detail, then notices it closed to new customers in November 2025. They consider dropping it to focus elsewhere.

They have already skipped CodeCommit for the same reason.

What should the candidate do?

- ☐ A Keep studying Migration Hub: it is on the in-scope list, unlike CodeCommit, and remains a correct answer
- ☐ B Drop it, consistent with the CodeCommit decision
- ☐ C Study AWS Transform instead, as the successor
- ☐ D Study both Migration Hub and AWS Transform equally

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the candidate do?

- A

 Keep it; it is on the list
Closure is not the test. Migration Hub is on the in-scope list and CodeCommit is not, which is the only difference that matters.
- B

 Drop it for consistency
Consistent application of the wrong rule. The rule is not "closed means skip"; it is "not on the list means skip".
- C

 Study AWS Transform
The right service for the workplace and not on the in-scope list. It cannot be a correct answer on C02.
- D

 Study both
Half the effort spent on a service that cannot appear. Migration Hub alone is the examinable half.

THE SIGNAL

Pair this with scenario two. Same reasoning, opposite conclusion, because the in-scope list is the test rather than the closure date.

A practice question asks how to run SQL queries continuously over a streaming data source. The offered options include Amazon Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL, Amazon Managed Service for Apache Flink, AWS Glue streaming, and Amazon Athena.

The candidate recognises Kinesis Data Analytics from an older course.

What should the candidate conclude?

- ☐ A Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL was fully shut down in January 2026; Managed Service for Apache Flink is its replacement
- ☐ B Choose Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL, as the purpose-built option
- ☐ C Choose Athena, since the question mentions SQL
- ☐ D Choose AWS Glue streaming, since Flink is too complex

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the candidate conclude?

- A** It is shut down; Flink replaced it

Full shutdown on 27 January 2026, with Managed Service for Apache Flink named by AWS as the migration target. Recognition is not currency.
- B** Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL

It was the right answer for years, which is why it is recognised. It no longer exists in any capacity.
- C** Athena

Queries data at rest in S3. It does not run continuous queries over a stream.
- D** Glue streaming

A real option for streaming ETL, and the reasoning given is a preference rather than a requirement from the question.

THE SIGNAL

Recognising a service is the danger. Familiarity feels like knowledge, and here it is a memory of a service that has been removed.

A candidate encounters a service name in a practice question that they cannot place at all, and cannot tell whether it is very new, very old, or invented by the question author. They have twenty minutes of revision time left in the session.

The exam is in a fortnight.

What is the fastest way to resolve it?

- ☐ A Check the exam guide's in-scope list first, then the AWS Product Lifecycle page if it appears there
- ☐ B Search for tutorials and learn the service from scratch
- ☐ C Ignore it, since unfamiliar means unimportant
- ☐ D Ask in a forum and wait for a reply

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the fastest way to resolve it?

- A

In-scope list, then lifecycle page

Two lookups, under a minute. Not on the list means stop. On the list means learn it, and the lifecycle page tells you its status.
- B

Learn it from scratch

Twenty minutes on a service that may not be examinable at all. Establish relevance before depth.
- C

Ignore it

Unfamiliar may mean genuinely new and genuinely examinable, which is precisely the gap this course exists to close.
- D

Ask a forum

Slower than looking it up, and forum answers are frequently out of date in exactly the way this module describes.

THE SIGNAL

Establish relevance before depth. The in-scope list answers the only question that matters, and it answers it in seconds.

A team's runbook references AWS Data Pipeline for a nightly ETL job, and the job still runs. A new engineer proposes rebuilding it on Data Pipeline for consistency with the existing pattern.

The account has used Data Pipeline since 2021.

What should the solutions architect advise?

- ☐ A Data Pipeline closed to new customers in 2024; build new work on Step Functions or AWS Glue, and plan to migrate the existing job
- ☐ B Rebuild on Data Pipeline, since the account is an existing customer
- ☐ C Leave the existing job and build nothing new
- ☐ D Migrate everything to Data Pipeline for consistency

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect advise?

- A

 Build new work elsewhere, plan the migration
Being an existing customer permits continued use, and building new dependencies on a closed service deepens a problem with a known ending.
- B

 Rebuild on Data Pipeline
Technically possible as an existing customer, and it adds new work to a service receiving no features and heading for sunset.
- C

 Build nothing
Declines to solve the problem. The team needs the job; the question is where to build it.
- D

 Consolidate onto Data Pipeline
The worst option: it increases exposure to a closed service across more workloads.

THE SIGNAL

Existing customers can keep using a closed service. That is permission to continue, not a reason to expand onto it.

What to carry out of this module

- ◆ **The in-scope list is the test, not the closure date.** Migration Hub is dead and examinable; CodeCommit is dead and not.
- ◆ **OpsWorks, CodeStar, Elastic Transcoder, IoT Analytics and Kinesis Data Analytics for SQL are fully shut down.** Not closed. Gone.
- ◆ **A chapter on CodeCommit or Cloud9 dates a guide to before mid-2024,** which tells you what else to verify.
- ◆ **Establish relevance before depth.** The in-scope list answers the only question that matters, in seconds.

ON THE EXAM

AWS's Product Lifecycle page, from May 2025, is where to check. Maintenance, sunset and full shutdown mean different things.